CUSTOMER DISCOVERY CANVAS

FROM CUSTOMER PROBLEM TO MEASURABLE BUSINESS VALUE

CUSTOMER / PROJECT **Invoice Processing Efficiency** | FDE / TEAM **[Owner / team] Team 3** | DISCOVERY STAGE **[Initial / In progress / Validated] Initial** | VERSION **[Date / version] 31-Oct-2026**

01 CUSTOMER & STAKEHOLDERS

Who owns the problem? Who uses the process? Who makes decisions?

F

1. Finance Shared Services manages invoice processing across the organisation.
2. Suppliers, Accounts Payable teams, Procurement teams and business owners participate in the process.
3. The CFO has sponsored the discovery initiative due to operational concerns.

U

1. Who owns the end-to-end invoice lifecycle?
2. Which stakeholder group experiences the most pain?
3. Who approves process or technology investments?

D

1. Create a stakeholder map and identify accountability.

02 BUSINESS OBJECTIVE

Why change? What triggered the request? What matters most?

F

1. The organisation wants invoice processing to become more efficient and predictable.
2. Leadership wants to reduce unnecessary manual effort.
3. Supplier payments should be completed within expected timelines.

U

1. Which objective is the highest priority: efficiency, cost reduction or supplier experience?
2. What improvement target has management set?
3. How are current business goals being measured?

D

1. Align business priorities and success measures with leadership.

03 EXPECTED OUTCOMES

What should improve? How will we measure success?

F

1. Faster invoice processing is desired. [Testleaf_F...essing.pdf | PDF]
2. Better compliance with the 3-day SLA is expected. [Testleaf_F...essing.pdf | PDF]
3. Greater visibility into pending and delayed invoices is required. [Testleaf_F...essing.pdf | PDF]

U

1. What percentage improvement would be considered successful?
2. What reporting metrics should be tracked?
3. How will supplier satisfaction be measured?

D

1. Define measurable KPIs before designing solutions.

04 CURRENT PROCESS / AS-IS

What happens from request to closure? Where are handoffs?

F

1. Invoices are received, validated and eventually recorded in SAP.
2. Staff verify invoice details against purchase orders and supporting documents.
3. Email communication and spreadsheet tracking are still heavily used.

U

1. Which process steps consume the most time?
2. Where do handoffs create waiting periods?
3. Which activities remain fully manual?

D

1. Build an end-to-end process map and identify bottlenecks.

05 CORE PROBLEM & PAIN POINTS

What is going wrong? Which findings are verified?

F

1. Some invoices exceed the expected processing timeline.
2. Employees spend significant effort investigating discrepancies and chasing approvals.
3. Managers lack sufficient visibility into work queues and pending invoices.

U

1. What is the biggest source of delay?
2. Are process, data or system issues responsible?
3. Which exception types occur most frequently?

D

1. Validate the true root causes before recommending changes.

06 BUSINESS IMPACT & BASELINE

How often? What cost, time, risk or rework results?

F

1. Delays may increase operational overhead.
2. Month-end processing creates additional pressure on teams.
3. Supplier experience may be affected by slower responses and payments.

U

1. How many invoices miss the SLA?
2. What is the cost of manual effort and rework?
3. How many supplier enquiries are received each month?

D

1. Establish baseline metrics before evaluating improvements.

07 DATA, SYSTEMS & CONSTRAINTS

What systems, data, rules and dependencies exist?

F

1. SAP is the primary finance application.
2. Email, spreadsheets and document repositories are used alongside SAP.
3. Invoice information comes from multiple sources and systems.

U

1. How well are the current systems integrated?
2. What data quality issues exist?
3. Which compliance requirements influence processing?

D

1. Analyse data flow and system dependencies before considering new technology.

08 REQUIREMENTS & MVP OPTIONS

What capabilities could help? What is the smallest useful pilot?

F

1. No solution approach has been selected yet.
2. The organisation is open to process, automation or AI-based improvements.
3. Recommendations must be supported by evidence from discovery.

U

1. Which area offers the highest business value?
2. What is the smallest pilot that can demonstrate measurable impact?
3. Which existing capabilities can be leveraged first?

D

1. Delay technology selection until causes and opportunities are validated.

09 VALIDATION & NEXT STEPS

What must be confirmed? Who owns each decision?

F

1. Current delay causes have not been proven.
2. Operational metrics require validation.
3. Month-end workload behaviour is not fully understood.

U

1. Why do invoices exceed the SLA?
2. What proportion of delays comes from approvals, discrepancies or workload spikes?
3. Which improvements will deliver the greatest business value?

D

1. Interview stakeholders, collect metrics and validate findings before proposing any solution.